

Chapter 157-8

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Huayi Media was a pretty good film and television company in the industry. From script development, IP selection, actors, screenwriters, to directors—it was practically a complete pipeline.

Moreover, they had been focused on the film and television industry for so many years.

In the years when talent shows had risen in popularity, Huayi Media hadn't thought about getting a piece of that pie and had always stayed focused on creating more and better films and dramas.

Yang Shuyan was signed to this company.

So the company was trustworthy—it just depended on the contract.

Liang Shi scheduled a meeting with their representative for ten o'clock the next morning, at a very ordinary café.

So ordinary that a cup of coffee cost less than 20 yuan, but the environment was surprisingly nice.

The Huayi representative was a short-haired girl with a small dimple when she smiled and very typical round eyes. She looked very approachable.

Based on her past experience, Liang Shi had drafted her own contract. Without much preamble, she went straight to the point and struck first.

When she brought out the contract, the girl was stunned.

She probably had never seen a newcomer bring their own contract when discussing collaboration. She struggled to hand over the contract she had brought, but Liang Shi's attitude was very firm. "I won't be looking at yours. The one I drafted is based on industry standards. You can take a look first—don't rush to reject it."

And just like that, Liang Shi went from a passive to an active position.

She sat there leisurely drinking coffee, and after about ten minutes, the other party had finished reading all the content of the contract.

There wasn't really anything too outrageous—it was almost the same as theirs, just with a few additional clauses regarding artist rights and contract termination protections.

Huayi was also a big company that had always valued developing their artists. Moreover, the company was governed primarily by "benevolence," and many big actors chose to stay with Huayi even after their contracts expired.

Because Huayi had good resources and was said to be backed by powerful capital, no one in the industry dared to mess with them.

Combined with their stable content output, they were considered one of the top talent agencies in terms of both reputation and strength, and wouldn't want to ruin their artist pipeline.

So after seeing this contract, the Huayi representative indeed didn't rush to reject it. Instead, she said: "I need to report this to my superior. You're quite unique. We're looking forward to working with you, but the contract terms need to be approved by our legal department before we can sign. So you can go home and wait for my message. I'll get back to you as soon as possible."

She was very polite to Liang Shi and didn't look down on her for being a lower-tier celebrity without any works.

So this person left a pretty good impression on Liang Shi.

For this reason, she even went so far as to message Zhao Ying, asking her what Huayi was like as a company and whether there were any hidden rules internally.

Zhao Ying was silent for a long time: 【Congratulations, little junior sister.】

Liang Shi:

Zhao Ying: 【I also signed with Huayi. We're about to be from the same agency.】

Liang Shi: "..."

After learning that Zhao Ying had also signed with Huayi, Liang Shi felt much more at ease.

She believed that her contract terms weren't too demanding, so she was quite confident about this collaboration.

Sure enough, a day later, the representative called Liang Shi and said her contract was acceptable and they could arrange the signing immediately.

Liang Shi went out again to sign the contract with them and took a tour around Huayi Media while she was there.

However, while walking around, she heard their employees whispering constantly. After a trip to the restroom, she figured out what was going on.

Apparently, there had been some turbulence in Huayi's upper management recently, and some unknown capital was trying to acquire Huayi.

Everyone gossiped for quite a while, and finally one person summed it up: "What does it have to do with me? I'm just here to work anyway."

Later, this matter fizzled out with no resolution.

Even Zhao Ying didn't know about it.

However, after signing with Huayi, she added her agent on WeChat. This agent was also quite famous in the industry. Countless artists had been made famous under her guidance, but she was particularly passionate about mentoring newcomers.

She said she really enjoyed the sense of achievement.

After Liang Shi added her, she was also pulled into a group chat with five people, all newcomers who had been signed to the company in the same batch.

Among them was Tang Zui, who had filmed "Mo Xin"¹ with her.

And Tang Zui said that Qi Tang had signed with another good talent agency.

This was probably the boost from Gu Yixue's film.

Although the casting and filming news for "Mo Xin" hadn't been publicly announced, basically everyone who was well-connected in the industry knew about it.

Some directors would even recommend actors to these talent agencies.

These talent agencies were probably thinking: how bad could someone who could act in a Gu Yixue film be?

However, for some reason, Sun Chengcheng hadn't been signed.

Perhaps she had gone after higher goals.

For this agent to manage five people at once would seem slightly difficult.

But clearly, she had already adapted to this method of collectively managing artists, and all her arrangements were very organized.

She first scheduled a meeting with everyone, and after the meeting, discussed career planning with each of them.

Among the artists signed in the same batch, all had acted before, and those artists all had works currently airing. Only Liang Shi and Tang Zui's works hadn't aired yet. But once they heard these two had acted in a Gu Yixue film, the others looked at them with indescribable envy.

Someone recognized Liang Shi and said she had been following her all along. She had gone viral with a set of photos in red clothing, and later someone even compared her red dress photos to Yang Shuyan's, concluding that each had their own merits.

The persona of a glamorous beauty with endless charm had been established on the internet.

So before meeting her in person, she had always thought Liang Shi was that kind of gorgeous, aloof, and arrogant queen. Only after meeting her did she discover she was actually a gentle older sister whose smile was so sweet.

Liang Shi even teased: "So does this count as breaking my persona?"

The young girl immediately waved her hands: "No, no, no, this is a new understanding."

You could tell within a few sentences whether an agent was capable or not.

Having gotten used to Sister Wang's swift and decisive work style, Liang Shi also accepted this new agent well—she was of the same caliber as Sister Wang.

However, the newcomers who hadn't signed with a company before were all a bit intimidated by this agent.

Tang Zui even whispered to her: "Sis, aren't you scared?"

"Why would I be scared of her?" Liang Shi said. "She's quite nice."

Tang Zui: "?"

Tang Zui felt like she didn't understand anymore.

When discussing career planning with her, Liang Shi said: "Act properly and behave. Necessary social engagements are fine, but not too many. For variety shows and such, only go on quality ones. Absolutely no over-marketing or excessive entertainment-ification, because all variety shows and endorsements are based on commercial value, and commercial value comes from works. This way, when people try to slander me, I can stand up and say I got to where I am today through my works."

The agent really appreciated her answer because it aligned with Huayi's philosophy.

Because the meeting with the agent went quite well, Liang Shi's mood improved somewhat.

She even took the initiative to ask Gu Yixue when she planned to crash the wedding.

In one more day, it would be the ten-day deadline that Shen Fenghe had mentioned.

Gu Yixue sent her a voice message in the middle of the night: "Tomorrow is the promotional release for 'Mo Xin.' Remember to repost on Weibo."

It was already the day before crashing the wedding, and Gu Yixue was still working hard. When Liang Shi saw her message, she replied instantly: 【Got it.】

Gu Yixue was surprised: "Why aren't you asleep yet?"

Liang Shi: "I've been having insomnia lately."

Unlike Xu Qingzhu, she wasn't having nightmares—she simply couldn't fall asleep.

Gu Yixue didn't ask why she had insomnia. After all, for modern people, having an unholy sleep schedule² was pretty normal.

Instead, she answered Liang Shi's question: "On the day of her wedding, if Gu Chunmian doesn't show up, then I will."

Liang Shi: 【Brave!】

Liang Shi: 【I'll carry the wedding dress for you and be your driver.】

Gu Yixue: 【...Deal.】

And so the two of them casually finalized this matter in the middle of the night.

However, the day before Shen Fenghe's wedding, Liang Shi received a message from an unfamiliar number: 【Are you busy right now? I'd like to meet with you. —Gu Xingyue】

Gu Xingyue, who hadn't contacted her in a long time, suddenly sent a message. Liang Shi immediately replied: 【Yes, I'm free!】

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1. "Mo Xin" (心途) - The English title used in earlier translations was "Mo Xin" or could be translated as "Heart's Journey." This is the film directed by Gu Yixue that Liang Shi acted in. ↩
 2. The original Chinese phrase "阴间作息" (yīnjiān zuòxi) literally means "underworld/netherworld sleep schedule," referring to sleeping during the day and being awake at night like ghosts. It's internet slang used by young Chinese people to describe unhealthy sleep patterns, particularly staying up very late or having completely reversed day-night schedules. ↩